

JANUARY–APRIL		MAY–AUGUST		SEPTEMBER–DECEMBER		JANUARY–MARCH 1973			
FEBRUARY 21–28 President Nixon visits communist China and meets with Chairman Mao Zedong, leading to a rapprochement between the US and China.	MARCH 30 The NVA launches the Easter Offensive, a large-scale invasion of South Vietnam, using armored vehicles and artillery to strike across the DMZ toward the city of Quang Tri.		MAY 11–28 An LOC and American coast guard ships are sunk in devastating strikes against the attackers.	JUNE 28 A large NVA force in northern South Vietnam launches a counteroffensive with the aim of retaking Quang Tri province.	OCTOBER 22 The communist Easter Offensive ends. The American Lindebacher bombing campaign against North Vietnam is halted.	NOVEMBER 14 Nixon assures President Thieu that Hanoi does not abide by the terms of the proposed peace deal. The US will withdraw its military and security.	DECEMBER 20 US B-52 bombers are shot down by North Vietnamese SAMs, facing a revision of American bombing tactics.	JANUARY 9 Peace talks resume in Paris; a breakthrough is announced.	FEBRUARY 12 Operation Homecoming—the transfer of US prisoners of war from North Vietnam to the United States—begins.
APRIL 4 In response to the Easter Offensive, President Nixon authorizes the bombing of North Vietnam up to the 18th parallel.	APRIL 10 B-52 bombers begin large-scale raids on targets deep inside North Vietnam as America escalates the air war.	MAY 1 The city of Quang Tri is occupied by the NVA as South Vietnamese troops retreat southward in disorder.	MAY 17 President Nixon approves Operation Endgame, the provision of large quantities of American military equipment to the South Vietnamese armed forces.	JULY 20 The city of An Loc ends in an NVA defeat after 55 days of fighting.	SEPTEMBER 16 South Vietnamese forces retake Quang Tri City, lost to the communists at the start of May.	DECEMBER 14 As peace negotiations in Paris stall, Nixon and his advisers decide to resume the bombing of North Vietnam.			
MARCH 10 The US 101st Airborne Division leaves South Vietnam, the last US ground combat division to be withdrawn. Vietnamization is complete.	APRIL 7 After a three-day battle, North Vietnamese and Viet Cong forces capture the town of Loc Ninh, near the Cambodian border north of Saigon.	APRIL 12 Communist forces advance from base areas in Laos and Cambodia toward Kontum.	MAY 8 President Nixon orders the mining of Haiphong Harbor and other North Vietnamese ports to block the import of war materiel.			DECEMBER 18 Operation Lindebacher II, known as the Christmas Bombing, begins. American B-52 bombers attack targets in Hanoi and Haiphong.	FEBRUARY 21 A peace agreement is signed between the Royal Lao government and the Pathet Lao. The US bombing of Laos is halted.		
	APRIL 27 US Marines, armed with laser-guided bombs strike the Thanh Hoa bridge, a vital communications link in North Vietnam.	APRIL 13 The city of An Loc, north of Saigon, comes under attack and its defenses are placed under siege by communist forces.	MAY 10 US Marines begin Operation Endgame, a sustained bombing campaign against North Vietnam, which attacks military installations, supply routes, and storage facilities.	JUNE 9 Communist forces are cleared from Kontum City, ending the threat of South Vietnam being cut in two.	AUGUST 11 The last combat patrol carried out by American troops in Vietnam is completed near Da Nang.	OCTOBER 8 Henry Kissinger, North Vietnamese negotiator Le Duc Tho and US National Security Advisor Henry Kissinger agree a draft peace agreement.		JANUARY 21 President Nixon reluctantly accepts the proposed peace terms. The "tentative" begins a resumption of peace negotiations in January.	
				JUNE 27 US Navy spears carry out a night raid against the defenses of the port of Haiphong.	OCTOBER 20 The US begins Operation Endgame II, the supply of military equipment and supplies of arms to South Vietnam ahead of an expected peace agreement.	NOVEMBER 7 Richard Nixon is re-elected as president in a landslide victory, winning over 60 percent of the popular vote.	DECEMBER 29 Lindebacher II is halted. The US Air Force has lost 16 B-52s shot down in the raids. The bombing has caused 1,624 civilian deaths.	JANUARY 27 The Paris Peace Accords are signed. The provisions include a ceasefire and the withdrawal of all American forces from Vietnam within 60 days.	MARCH 29 The last American combat troops leave Vietnam. More than 58,000 Americans have died in the conflict.

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